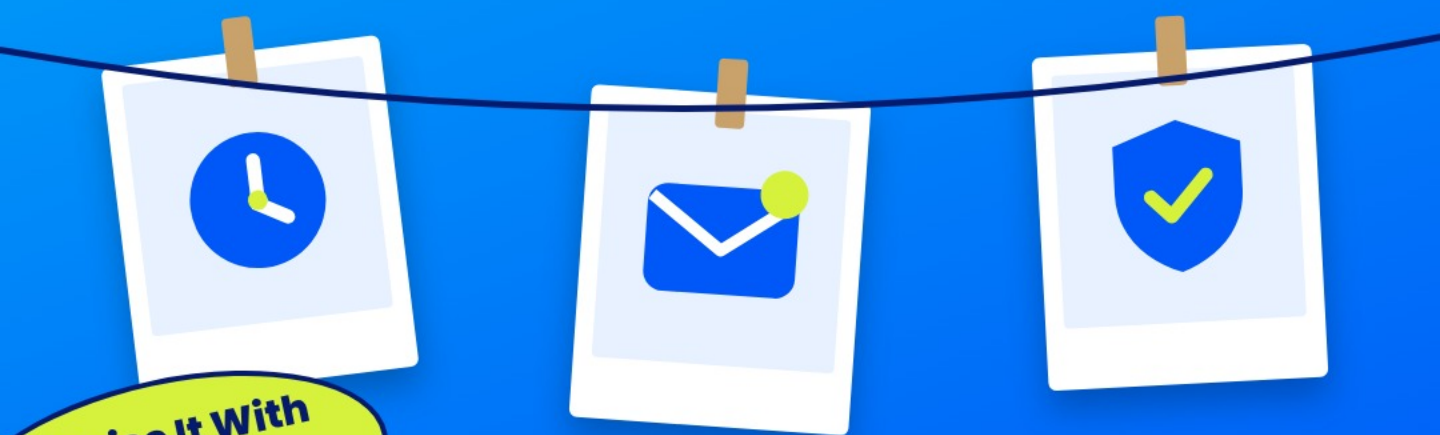
VRITIMES

media relations

embargoes: how to use them without burning bridges



Raise It With Press Release

swipe →

VRITIMES

01

what an embargo is

A request that journalists don't publish before a set date and time. It gives them time to prepare a better story. It is an **agreement**, not a legal contract.

02

when it's worth it

Complex news that needs time: research findings, funding rounds, product launches with demos. If the news fits in one sentence, you probably don't need one.

03

ask before you send

Offer the news under embargo and wait for a yes. Sending embargoed material unasked and hoping it's honoured is how leaks happen.

VRITIMES

04 timezone-proof timing

Write the full time and zone, and check it against the journalist's timezone.

example

"EMBARGOED UNTIL 6:00am AEDT, Tuesday 24 November 2026"

05

respect their workload

Journalists are stretched: 62% took on more responsibilities this year. Give enough lead time (two to five working days for most news) and everything they need in one go.

Source: Muck Rack, State of Journalism 2025

embargo checklist

- [ ] News complex enough to need prep time
- [ ] Journalist agreed before receiving details
- [ ] Date, time AND timezone in the subject line
- [ ] Assets, data and spokesperson ready on day one
- [ ] A plan if it breaks early

media relations

VRITIMES

embargo = trust. treat it that way.

1. Save this checklist
2. Send it to whoever runs your launches

Source:
· Muck Rack, State of Journalism 2025